STARTER PACK

# Welcome: start here

خوش آمدید

This pack has what you need for the first week: an alphabet chart, a vowel-marks card, and Unit 1 (the first six letters).



## 1 Print

- A4 paper, portrait, “actual size”. Black and white is fine.
- Pencils (HB) and a rubber for the child. A soft pencil is easier to trace with.

## 2 Sit down

- 10 minutes, once a day. Stop while the child still wants more.
- Sit on the child’s left so your hand does not hide the page.

## 3 Remember three things

- Urdu goes **right to left**. Start on the right of the page.
- Letters **join**, and change shape. The chart shows all the shapes.
- **Body first, dots last.** Write the whole word, then add the dots.

## 4 What is inside

1. Alphabet chart in teaching order (2 pages)
2. Vowel marks card
3. Unit 1: guide, trace sheets for the six letters, look-alikes, join the letters, reading practice, unit check, answer keys

More sheets for every unit are in the app, under Practice sheets.

# Alphabet chart: the order we teach

حروفِ تہجی

39 letters. Each card: the letter alone, then its shape at the start, middle and end of a word (read from the right).

**1 alif**
الف
'a' in father when long
ا
ـا (end)

**2 be**
بے
'b' in bat
ب
ـب (end) · ـبـ (middle) · بـ (start)

**3 kāf**
کاف
'k' in kite
ک
ـک (end) · ـکـ (middle) · کـ (start)

**4 lām**
لام
'l' in log
ل
ـل (end) · ـلـ (middle) · لـ (start)

**5 mīm**
میم
'm' in mat
م
ـم (end) · ـمـ (middle) · مـ (start)

**6 nūn**
نون
'n' in net
ن
ـن (end) · ـنـ (middle) · نـ (start)

**7 te**
تے
soft dental 't', tongue on the teeth
ت
ـت (end) · ـتـ (middle) · تـ (start)

**8 choṭī ye**
چھوٹی ے
'y' in yes at the start
ی
ـی (end) · ـیـ (middle) · یـ (start)

**9 baṛī ye**
بڑی ے
'ay' in day
ے
ـے (end)

**10 pe**
پے
'p' in pat
پ
ـپ (end) · ـپـ (middle) · پـ (start)

**11 ṭe**
ٹے
hard English 't' in tap, tongue curled back
ٹ
ـٹ (end) · ـٹـ (middle) · ٹـ (start)

**12 ṣe**
ثے
's' in sun
ث
ـث (end) · ـثـ (middle) · ثـ (start)

**13 wāʾo**
واؤ
'w'/'v' at the start
و
ـو (end)

**14 re**
رے
tapped 'r'
ر
ـر (end)

**15 dāl**
دال
soft dental 'd', tongue on the teeth
د
ـد (end)

**16 choṭī he (gol he)**
ہے / گول ہے
'h' in hat
ہ
ـہ (end) · ـہـ (middle) · ہـ (start)

**17 sīn**
سین
's' in sun
س
ـس (end) · ـسـ (middle) · سـ (start)

**18 shīn**
شین
'sh' in shop
ش
ـش (end) · ـشـ (middle) · شـ (start)

**19 jīm**
جیم
'j' in jam
ج
ـج (end) · ـجـ (middle) · جـ (start)

**20 che**
چے
'ch' in chair
چ
ـچ (end) · ـچـ (middle) · چـ (start)

**21 gāf**
گاف
'g' in go
گ
ـگ (end) · ـگـ (middle) · گـ (start)

# Alphabet chart: the order we teach

حروفِ تہجی

39 letters. Each card: the letter alone, then its shape at the start, middle and end of a word (read from the right).

**22 nūn g̱hunna**
نون غنہ
nasalises the vowel before it, like French
ں
ـں end

**23 do-chashmī he**
دو چشمی ہے
a puff of breath after the letter before
ھ
ـھ end ـھـ middle ھـ start

**24 ḍāl**
ڈال
hard English 'd' in dad, tongue curled back
ڈ
ـڈ end

**25 ṛe**
ڑے
a flapped 'r'/'d' made with the tongue
ڑ
ـڑ end

**26 ze**
زے
'z' in zoo
ز
ـز end

**27 zhe**
ژے
's' in pleasure
ژ
ـژ end

**28 fe**
فے
'f' in fat
ف
ـف end ـفـ middle فـ start

**29 qāf**
قاف
a 'k' made far back in the throat
ق
ـق end ـقـ middle قـ start

**30 k̲he**
خے
'ch' in Scottish loch
خ
ـخ end ـخـ middle خـ start

**31 g̱hain**
غین
a gargled 'g', like the French 'r'
غ
ـغ end ـغـ middle غـ start

**32 ‘ain**
عین
in Urdu it mostly just carries the vowel
ع
ـع end ـعـ middle عـ start

**33 baṛī ḥe**
بڑی حے
'h' in hat
ح
ـح end ـحـ middle حـ start

**34 ṣwād**
صاد
's' in sun
ص
ـص end ـصـ middle صـ start

**35 ẓwād**
ضاد
'z' in zoo
ض
ـض end ـضـ middle ضـ start

**36 ṭo’e**
طوے
soft 't'
ط
ـط end ـطـ middle طـ start

**37 ẓo’e**
ظوے
'z' in zoo
ظ
ـظ end ـظـ middle ظـ start

**38 ẕāl**
ذال
'z' in zoo
ذ
ـذ end

**39 hamza**
ہمزہ
a tiny break between two vowels
ئ
ـئ end ـئـ middle ئـ start

# Vowel marks and signs

حرکات

The small marks are written above or below a letter. They tell you the short vowel. We keep them in every word until unit 11.

بَ

**zabar** زبر

short a (as in 'but')

بَس

bas · enough

بِ

**zer** زیر

short i (as in 'bit')

دِل

dil · heart

بُ

**pesh** پیش

short u (as in 'put')

گُل

gul · flower

بْ

**jazm (sukūn)** جزم

no vowel after this letter

سَبْزی

sabzī · vegetable

بّ

**tashdīd** تشدید

double the letter

بچّہ

bachcha · child

بٰ

**khaṛā zabar** کھڑا زبر

long ā without alif

اعلیٰ

a'lā · high

## Long vowels

| Letter | Sound | Example | Reads as |
|---|---|---|---|
| ا | ā | کام | kām |
| آ | ā (word start) | آم | ām |
| ی | ī | تین | tīn |
| و | ū | جوتا | jūtā |
| و | o | روٹی | roṭī |
| ے | e | لے | le |
| ے | ai | ہے | hai |
| و | au | اور | aur |
| ی | ai (mid-word) | میں | maiṉ |

## Numbers

| ۹ | ۸ | ۷ | ۶ | ۵ | ۴ | ۳ | ۲ | ۱ | ۰ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 9 | 8 | 7 | 6 | 5 | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 | 0 |

## Signs

۔ full stop · ، comma · ؟ question mark · ؛ semicolon

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

# Unit 1: The first six

پہلے چھ حرف

## 1 In this unit



Joiners vs the non-joiner alif; alif as long ā; the three short-vowel marks zabar, zer, pesh.

**How long:** About 3 hours for a child, 1.5 for an adult. Do 10 minutes a day, short and happy.

ن م ل ک ب ا

## 2 What to say and show, letter by letter

| | Say | How the pen moves | Often mixed up with |
|---|---|---|---|
| ا | **alif** الف<br>'a' in father when long | one stroke, top to bottom | lām |
| ب | **be** بے<br>'b' in bat | start top-right, shallow bowl leftwards, hook up; dot last | nūn |
| ک | **kāf** کاف<br>'k' in kite | base stroke first, right to left, then the sloping cap on top | none yet |
| ل | **lām** لام<br>'l' in log | tall stroke down, curve into the bowl | alif |
| م | **mīm** میم<br>'m' in mat | small loop, tail down-left | none yet |
| ن | **nūn** نون<br>'n' in net | deep round bowl; dot last | be |

## 3 How to use the sheets

1. **Trace and write**: one page per letter. Start at the dot, follow the arrow; body first, dots last.
2. **Look-alikes**: circle the same letter, then sort by dots.
3. **Join the letters**: standing letters into a joined word.
4. **Read and match**: word to meaning.
5. **Reading practice**: words, sentences, story.
6. **Dictation**: the grown-up says it, the child writes it.
7. **Unit check**: 10 questions. The answer key is the last page of the unit-check PDF; in the unit pack the keys are on the last pages.

## 4 How to check

- **Letters:** cover the sound, point to the letter, the child says it. 3 of 4 right is a pass.
- **Writing:** look at the start dot and the direction, not at how pretty it is. Right to left, body first, dots last.
- **Unit check:** 8 of 10 means go on. Under 8: redo the look-alike and trace sheets, try again tomorrow.
- **Praise** effort: “you started on the right”, “good dots”. One sheet a day beats five at once.

## 5 A 10-minute sitting

**2 min** warm-up: point to last time’s letters, the child says them. **5 min** the sheet of the day: say it, trace it, write it. **3 min** read it back together and end on something done well.

# Trace and write: alif

الف

Name _____ Date _____

## alif الف



Sound: 'a' in father when long

the body only: no dots

**How the pen moves:** one stroke, top to bottom.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

**Alone**

**Again, alone**

**End of a word (the letter before it joins to it, it does not join forward)**

**From memory: write it alone**

**In a word: ab (now)**

آب

# Trace and write: be

بے

Name _____ Date _____

## be بے



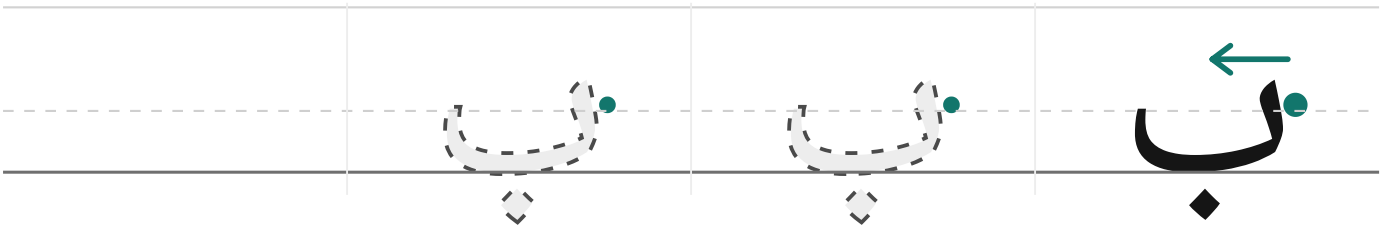
Sound: 'b' in bat

step 1: the body | step 2: 1 dot

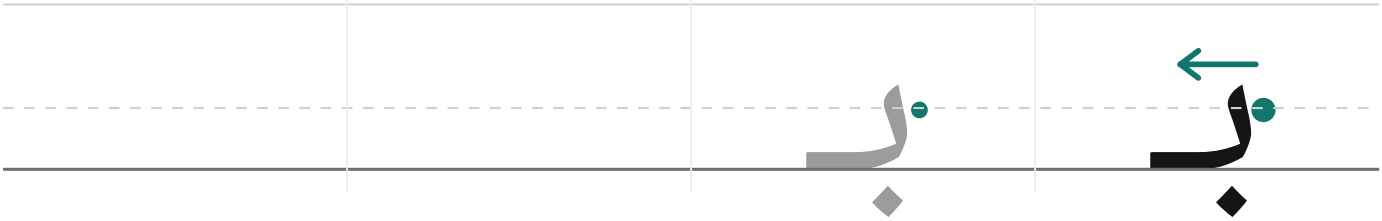
**How the pen moves:** start top-right, shallow bowl leftwards, hook up; dot last.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

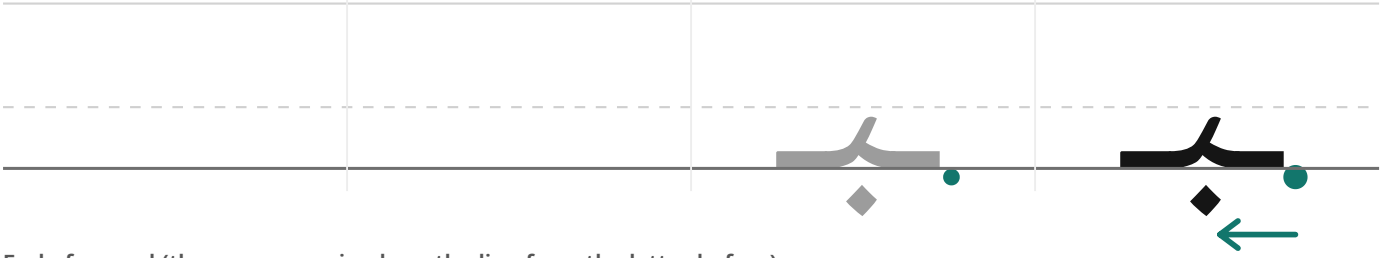
**Alone**



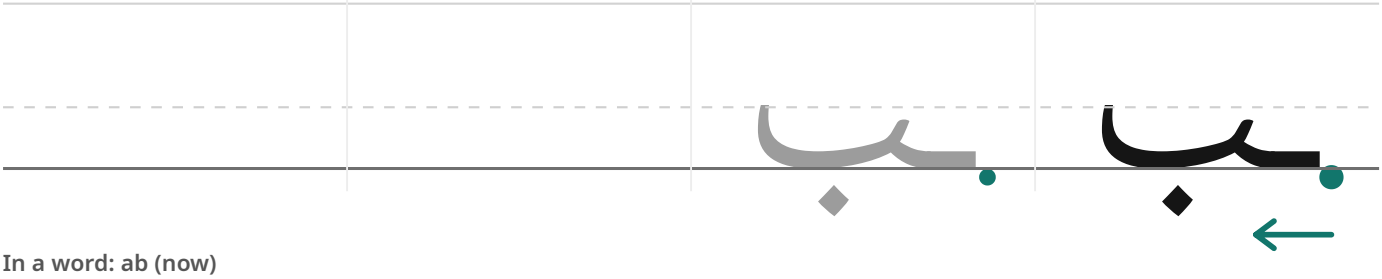
**Start of a word (joins to the next letter)**



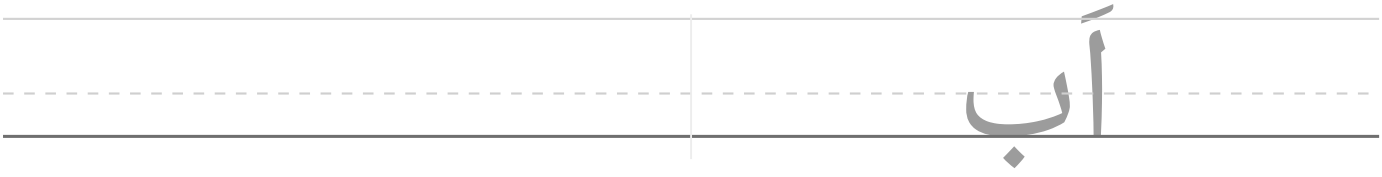
**Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)**



**End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)**



**In a word: ab (now)**



# Trace and write: kāf

کاف

Name _____ Date _____

## kāf کاف



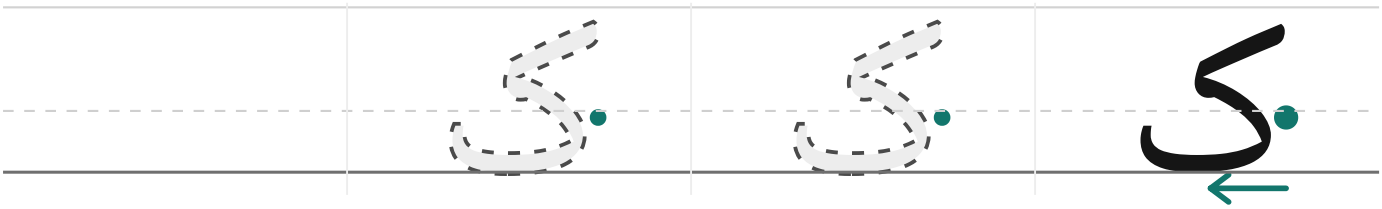
Sound: 'k' in kite

**the body only: no dots**

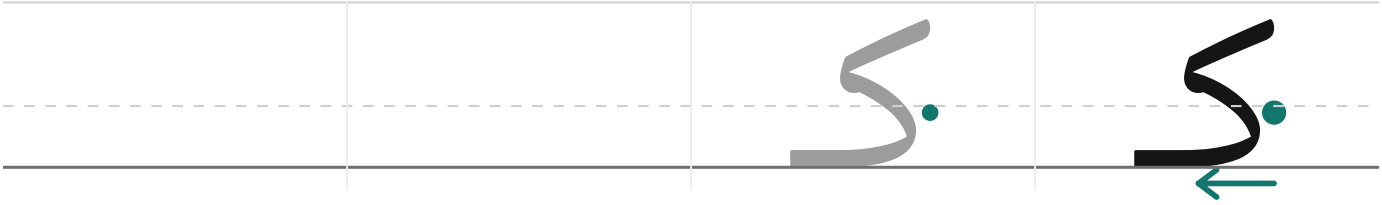
**How the pen moves:** base stroke first, right to left, then the sloping cap on top.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

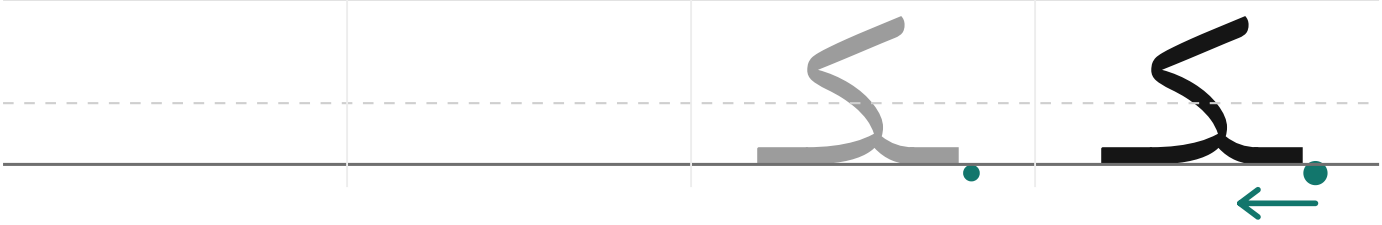
**Alone**



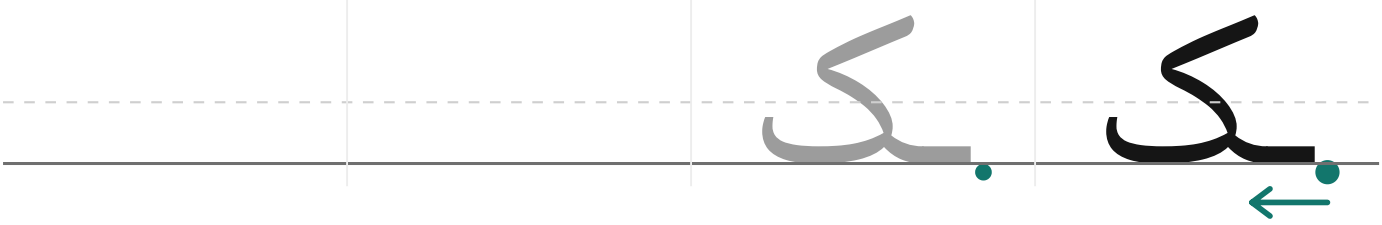
**Start of a word (joins to the next letter)**



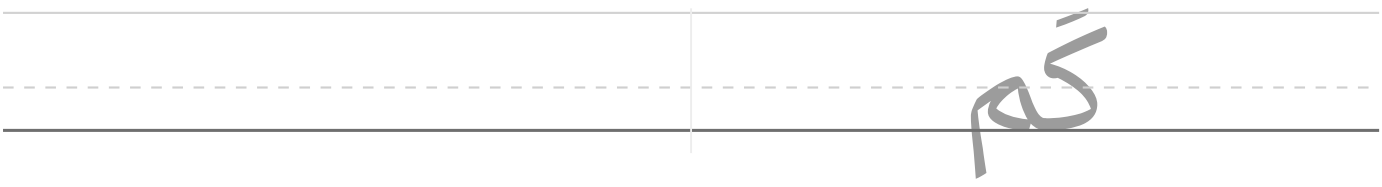
**Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)**



**End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)**



**In a word: kam (few, less)**

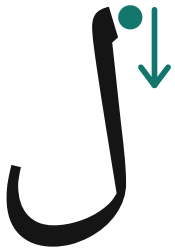


# Trace and write: lām

لام

Name _____ Date _____

## lām لام



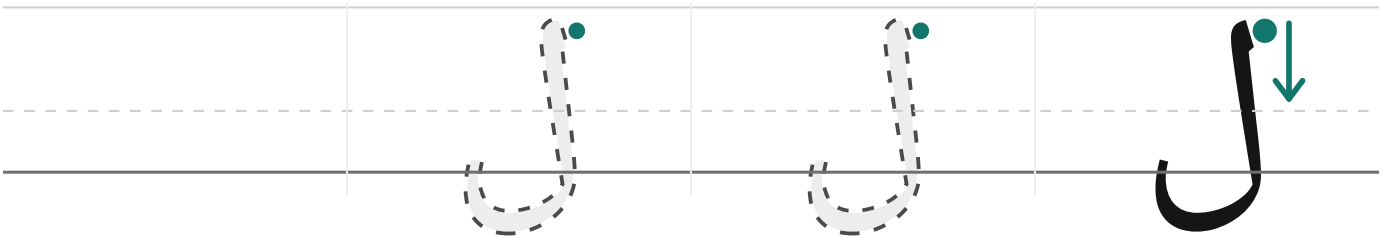
Sound: 'l' in log

the body only: no dots

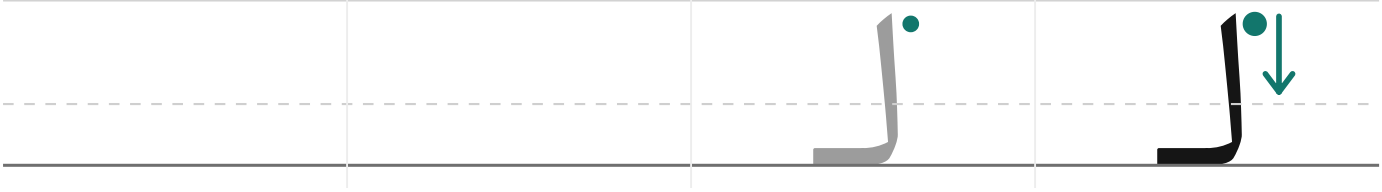
**How the pen moves:** tall stroke down, curve into the bowl.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

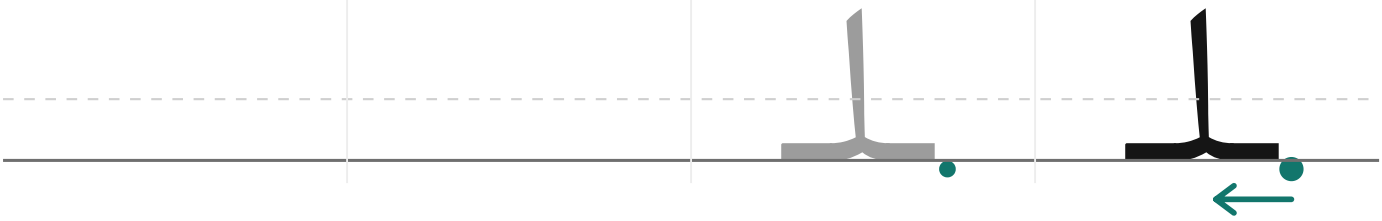
**Alone**



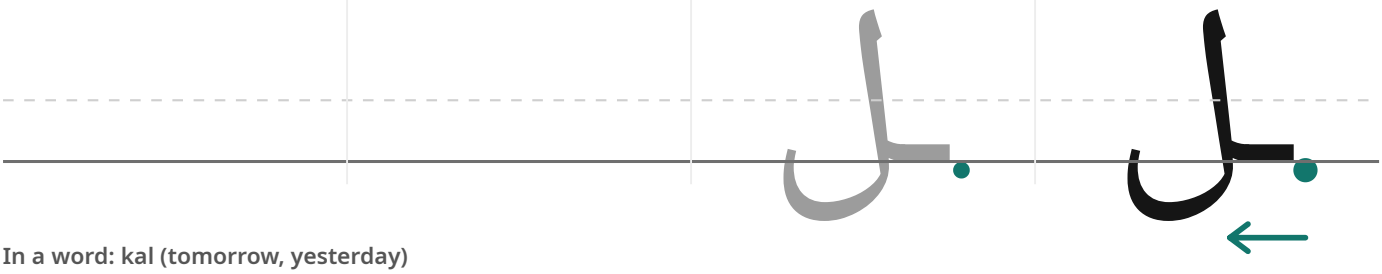
**Start of a word (joins to the next letter)**



**Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)**



**End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)**



**In a word: kal (tomorrow, yesterday)**



# Trace and write: mīm

میم

Name _____ Date _____

## mīm میم

Sound: 'm' in mat

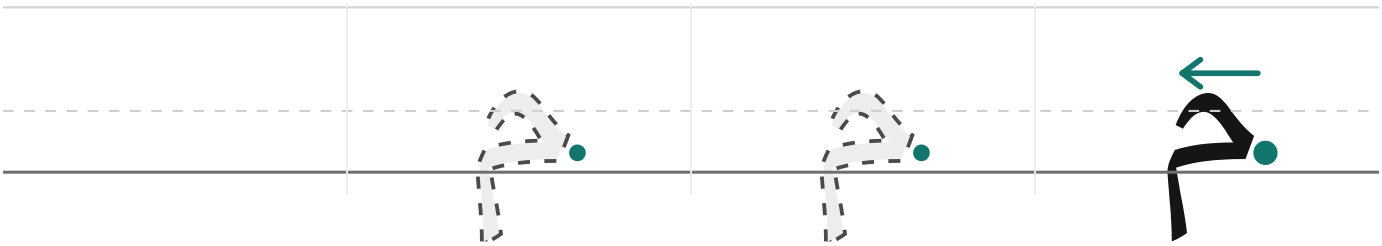
**the body only: no dots**

**How the pen moves:** small loop, tail down-left.

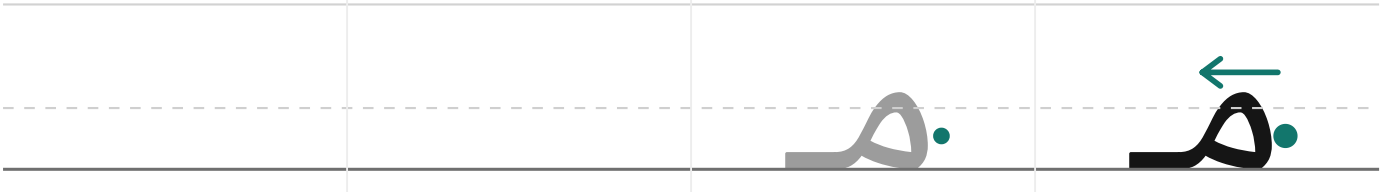
● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.



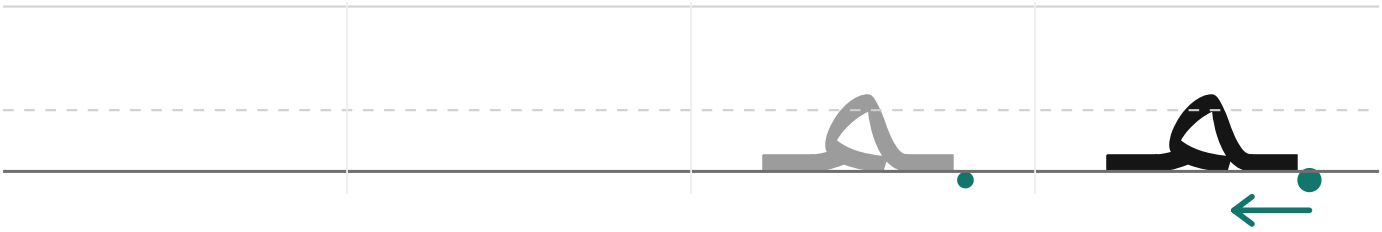
**Alone**



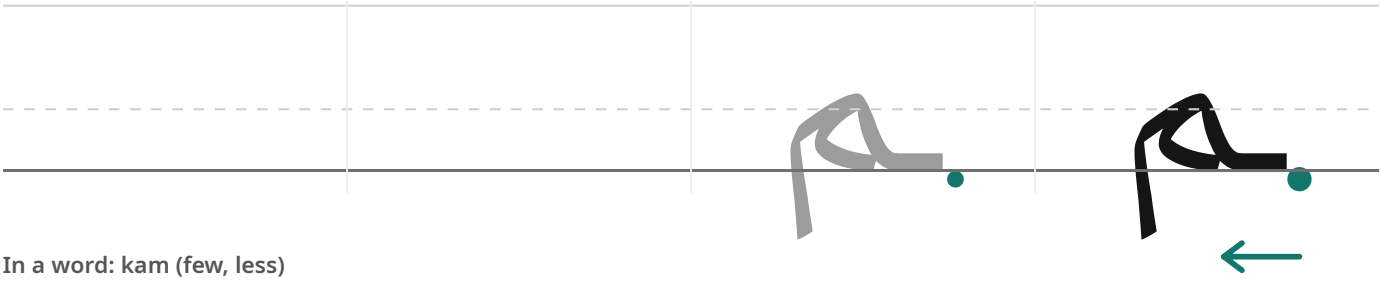
**Start of a word (joins to the next letter)**



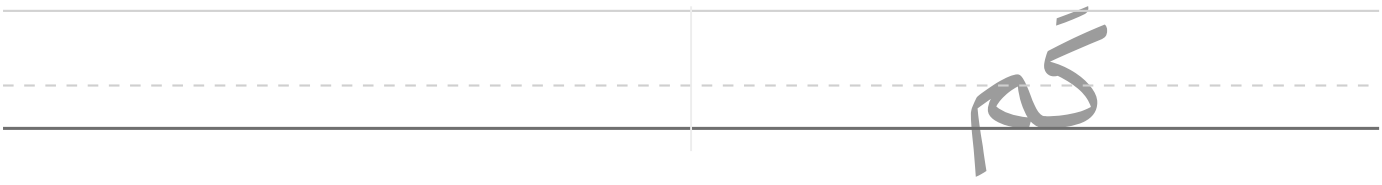
**Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)**



**End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)**



**In a word: kam (few, less)**



# Trace and write: nūn

نون

Name _____ Date _____

## nūn نون



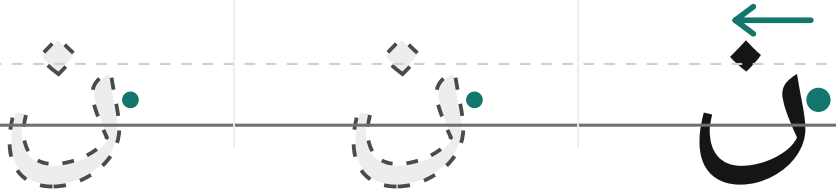
Sound: 'n' in net

step 1: the body | step 2: 1 dot

**How the pen moves:** deep round bowl; dot last.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

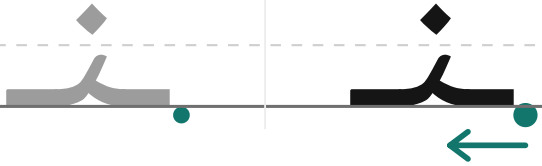
**Alone**



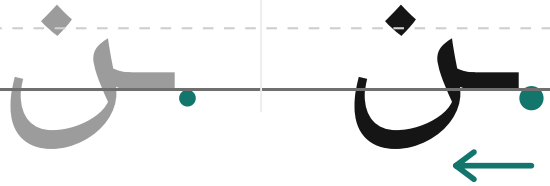
**Start of a word (joins to the next letter)**



**Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)**



**End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)**



**In a word: nām (name)**

نام

# Look-alike letters

ملتے جلتے حرف

Name _____ Date _____

**1** **Circle every letter that is the same as the big one on the right.**

| | |
|---|---|
| ک م ا ل ا ن ا | ا |
| ک ب ب ل ب ن ا | ب |
| ک ک ل ا ک ن م | ک |
| ل ک ا ب ل ن م | ل |
| م م ل ا ک ن ب | م |
| ب ن ل ن ک ا ن | ن |

**2** **Count the dots on each letter. Write the letter again in the box with that many dots.**

ل ب ک م ن ا

| No dots | 1 dot |
|---|---|
| | |

# Join the letters into a word

حرف جوڑیں

Name _____ Date _____

**1** **The letters are standing alone. Join them into a word. Read it out loud.**

Joined letters change shape. Write the word from right to left. The first two words on each page have a grey guide to trace.

**1**

ب + ا + ل + کُ + ل

Say: bilkul (absolutely)

بِالکُل

**2**

م + ا + لِ + ک

Say: mālik (owner)

مالِک

**3**

لَ + مْ + ب + ا

Say: lambā (long, tall)

**4**

اِ + مْ + ک + ا + ن

Say: imkān (possibility)

# Join the letters into a word

حرف جوڑیں

Name _____ Date _____

**1** **The letters are standing alone. Join them into a word. Read it out loud.**

Joined letters change shape. Write the word from right to left. The first two words on each page have a grey guide to trace.

**5**

م + ا + ل + کَ

Say: kalām (speech, words)

کَلام

**6**

ل + ا + م + کَ

Say: kamāl (perfection, skill)

کَمال

**7**

م + ا + ک + ا + ن

Say: nākām (unsuccessful)

**8**

ن + کِ + مْ + مُ + ا + ن

Say: nāmumkin (impossible)

# Read the words

پڑھنے کی مشق

Name _____ Date _____

**1** **Read each word. Colour a circle each time you read it smoothly (three tries).**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| اِمْکان ○○○ | لَمْبا ○○○ | مالِک ○○○ | بِالکُل ○○○ |
| نامُمْکِن ○○○ | ناکام ○○○ | کَمال ○○○ | کَلام ○○○ |
| کَمان ○○○ | نِکالْنا ○○○ | مَکان ○○○ | کامِل ○○○ |
| کَمانا ○○○ | مِلانا ○○○ | کَمْبَل ○○○ | مِلْنا ○○○ |
| مِلا ○○○ | مُلْک ○○○ | نام ○○○ | کام ○○○ |

**Grown-up corner.** Say a word, let the child repeat it, then point. Sounds and meanings, from the right: bilkul (absolutely) · mālik (owner) · lambā (long, tall) · imkān (possibility) · kalām (speech, words) · kamāl (perfection, skill) · nākām (unsuccessful) · nāmumkin (impossible) · kāmil (perfect) · makān (house) · nikālnā (to take out) · kamān (bow) · milnā (to meet) · kambal (blanket) · milānā (to mix, join) · kamānā (to earn) · kām (work) · nām (name) · mulk (country) · milā (met, got)

UNIT 1 · READING PRACTICE

# Read the words

پڑھنے کی مشق

Name _____ Date _____

**1** **Read each word. Colour a circle each time you read it smoothly (three tries).**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| بال ○○○ | بِنا ○○○ | مُکَمَّل ○○○ | مُمْکِن ○○○ |
| مال ○○○ | بَنانا ○○○ | ناک ○○○ | کالا ○○○ |
| مان ○○○ | کان ○○○ | نَمَک ○○○ | مانْنا ○○○ |
| لانا ○○○ | مالا ○○○ | اِملا ○○○ | کَباب ○○○ |
| مُنّا ○○○ | مَنانا ○○○ | کَم ○○○ | اَب ○○○ |

**Grown-up corner.** Say a word, let the child repeat it, then point. Sounds and meanings, from the right: bāl (hair) · binā (without) · mukammal (complete) · mumkin (possible) · māl (goods, wealth) · banānā (to make) · nāk (nose) · kālā (black) · mān (pride, honour) · kān (ear) · namak (salt) · mānnā (to accept, obey) · lānā (to bring) · mālā (garland) · imlā (spelling) · kabāb (kebab) · munnā (dear little boy) · manānā (to persuade, celebrate) · kam (few, less) · ab (now)

# Read the sentences

جملے پڑھیں

Name _____ Date _____

**2** **Read each line twice. Slide your finger under the words, right to left. Then trace it.**

بابا کا نام کَمال

بابا کا نام کَمال

نانا کا مَکان

نانا کا مَکان

کالا کَمْبَل لانا

کالا کَمْبَل لانا

# Read the story

کہانی پڑھیں

Name _____ Date _____

**3** **Read the story. Then ask: who? where? what happened?**

کَمال کا بابا۔ کَمال کا نانا۔ نانا کا مَکان لَمْبا۔ نانا کا کَمْبَل کالا۔ کَمال کا کام: نَمَک لانا۔



Time it: ____ seconds. Words in the story: 19. Words per minute = 19 × 60 ÷ seconds.

# For the grown-up: sounds and meanings

Read the lines aloud first, then let the child read them. Ask the three questions after the story.

**1.** bābā kā nām kamāl - dad's name is Kamal

**2.** nānā kā makān - grandfather's house

**3.** kālā kambal lānā - bring the black blanket

**Story.** kamāl kā bābā. kamāl kā nānā. nānā kā makān lambā. nānā kā kambal kālā. kamāl kā kām: namak lānā.

**Meaning.** Kamal's dad. Kamal's grandfather. Grandfather's house is long. Grandfather's blanket is black. Kamal's job: bringing salt.

# Unit 1 check

جانچ

Name _____ Date _____

A grown-up reads each prompt. No help with the letters. 10 questions, about 10 minutes.

**1** Say: “be” ('b' in bat)

ب ن ک م

**2** Say: “kāf” ('k' in kite)

ن ل ا ک

**3** Say: “lām” ('l' in log)

ا ب م ل

**4** How many dots does this letter have?

ن

0 1 2 3

**5** Say: “kal” (tomorrow, yesterday)

کَب کَل اَب

**6** Say: “milānā” (to mix, join)

مانْنا بَنانا مِلانا

**7** Say: “māl” (goods, wealth)

نان مال مِلا

**8** Join the letters and write the word. Say: “nāk”.

ک + ا + ن

_____

- - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - -

_____

**9** Join the letters and write the word. Say: “lambā”.

لَ + مْ + ب + ا

_____

- - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - -

_____

**10** Read this word out loud. Tick if it was right.

مِلا

☐ right ☐ needs help

**Score: _____ / 10** **8 or more: ready for the next unit**

# Answer key: unit 1

For the grown-up. Keep this page; the child does not need it.

## Look-alike letters, part 1: circle these (counting from the right)

| Letter | Circles |
|---|---|
| ا | 3, 5, 7 |
| ب | 3, 5, 6 |
| ک | 3, 6, 7 |
| ل | 3, 7 |
| م | 6, 7 |
| ن | 1, 4, 6 |

## Look-alike letters, part 2: the dot boxes

| Box | Letters |
|---|---|
| no dots | ا م ک ل |
| 1 dot | ب ن |

# Answer key: unit 1

For the grown-up. Keep this page; the child does not need it.

## Join the letters: the words

| # | Word | Say / meaning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | بِالکُل | bilkul (absolutely) |
| 2 | مالِک | mālik (owner) |
| 3 | لَمْبا | lambā (long, tall) |
| 4 | اِمْکان | imkān (possibility) |
| 5 | کَلام | kalām (speech, words) |
| 6 | کَمال | kamāl (perfection, skill) |
| 7 | ناکام | nākām (unsuccessful) |
| 8 | نامُمْکِن | nāmumkin (impossible) |

# Unit 1 check: answer key

Correct answers are circled. If the score is under 8: redo the look-alike sheet and the trace sheet for the letters that were missed, wait a day, try again.

**1** If wrong, redo: trace + look-alike sheets for this letter

Say: “be” ('b' in bat)

ب ن ک م

**2** If wrong, redo: trace + look-alike sheets for this letter

Say: “kāf” ('k' in kite)

ن ل ا ک

**3** If wrong, redo: trace + look-alike sheets for this letter

Say: “lām” ('l' in log)

ا ب م ل

**4** If wrong, redo: look-alike sheet, part 2

How many dots does this letter have?

ن

0 1 2 3

**5** If wrong, redo: read-and-match + reading practice

Say: “kal” (tomorrow, yesterday)

کَب کَل اَب

**6** If wrong, redo: read-and-match + reading practice

Say: “milānā” (to mix, join)

مِلانا بَنانا مانْنا

**7** If wrong, redo: read-and-match + reading practice

Say: “māl” (goods, wealth)

نان مال مِلا

**8** If wrong, redo: join-the-letters sheet

Join the letters and write the word. Say: “nāk”.

ک + ا + ن

ناک

**9** If wrong, redo: join-the-letters sheet

Join the letters and write the word. Say: “lambā”.

ا + ب + مْ + لَ

لَمْبا

**10** If wrong, redo: reading practice words

Read this word out loud. Tick if it was right.

مِلا

Answer: milā (met, got)